



A Step-by-Step Guide After the Loss of a Spouse or Family Member

Compassionate guidance for navigating life
after loss, one step at a time.

www.LifeBridgeGuidance.com

If you're reading this, you're likely experiencing one of the most painful and disorienting moments of your life.

Grief has a way of making even simple decisions feel impossible, and the pressure to 'handle things' can feel unbearable.

Please know this: it will be okay.

You do not need to have all the answers today. You do not need to do everything at once. And you do not need to go through this alone.

LifeBridge Guidance was created to walk beside families during loss — to help you slow things down, avoid costly mistakes, and move forward one step at a time with clarity and compassion. We are here to guide you, advocate for you, and help carry the weight when it feels too heavy.

Use this guide as a checklist. Do only what you can today. Tomorrow, we'll take the next step together.



Stabilize

Build a stable foundation
through grief and loss



Organize

Organize and prioritize
after a life-changing event



Rebuild

Work towards building
a hopeful, fulfilling future

Step 1 The First 24 Hours

Confirm the death

- ✓ Contact hospice, nurse, family, and right-way entity
- ✓ Arrange to have body moved

♡ Take care of immediate needs

- ✓ Secure the home
- ✓ Manage home or pet care
- ✓ Forward mail, if necessary
- ✓ Let family and friends know, as appropriate

♡ Contact a funeral home or mortuary

- ✓ Review disposition options and set up arrangements
- ✓ Get 24/7 assistance locating reputable providers

♡ Notify 2–3 key people

- ✓ Determine who needs to know right away
- ✓ Notify employer, close family, and close friends

Step 2 The First Week

(Critical but Often Overwhelming)

Order death certificates

- ✓ Request 10-15 certified copies
- ✓ Needed for banks, insurance, Social Security, property, and benefits

♡ Locate important documents

- ✓ Will and/or trust
- ✓ Marriage certificate
- ✓ Life insurance policies
- ✓ Recent bank, mortgage, credit card, and retirement
- ✓ Military discharge papers (if applicable)

♡ Identify who is legally in charge

- ✓ Trustee if there is a trust
- ✓ Executor if there is a will
- ✓ Court appointed administrator (if there is no plan)

♡ Notify Social Security

- ✓ Ask about survivor's benefits and dependent benefits

Step 3 Weeks Two Through Four

Turning Chaos into Order

This is the more intensive period, like hiring a Family Loss Concierge. During this phase address any bills, accounts, insurance, and secondary affairs.

Order death certificates

- ✓ Request 10-15 certified copies
- ✓ Needed for banks, insurance, Social Security, property, and benefits

♡ Locate important documents

- ✓ Will and/or trust
- ✓ Marriage certificate
- ✓ Life insurance policies
- ✓ Recent bank, mortgage, credit card, and retirement statements
- ✓ Military discharge papers (if applicable)

♡ Identify who is legally in charge

- ✓ Trustee if there is a trust
- ✓ Executor if there is a will
- ✓ Court appointed administrator (if there is no plan)

Step 4 Weeks Two Through Four

Turning Chaos into Order

This is when many families feel lost, frozen & family Law Concierge brings in both go-person resources, and technology-informed team.

Order death certificates

- ✓ Request 5-10 certified copies
- ✓ Needed for banks, insurance, Social Security, property, and benefits

Locate important documents

- ✓ Will and/or trust
- ✓ Life insurance policies
- ✓ Car, mortgage, and deeds
- ✓ Tax returns, bank accounts, credit card and retirement statements
- ✓ Military discharge papers (if applicable)

Identify who is legally in charge

- ✓ Beneficiary of an estate
- ✓ Executor of the will/trust
- ✓ Court-appointed administrator (if there is no plan)

Common Mistakes LifeBridge Guidance Helps Families Avoid

- ✓ Rushing financial decisions
- ✓ Paying debts that aren't legally yours
- ✓ Distributing money too early
- ✓ Feeling pressured by others
- ✓ Trying to do everything alone

You Don't Have to Carry This Alone

If you or someone you love is navigating life after loss, LifeBridge Guidance is here to help — compassionately, patiently, and step by step.

When you're ready, we'll take the next step together.